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# Tempe permanently bans city from using license plate reader cameras

The Tempe City Council decided Thursday night that the city won't be using automated license plate reader (ALPR) technology ever again.

By David Baker

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**TEMPE, AZ (AZFamily)** — The Tempe City Council decided Thursday night that the city won't be using automated license plate reader (ALPR) technology ever again.

The council approved a ban on the cameras in a 6-1 vote, with Vice Mayor Arlene Chin being the lone holdout.

The new ordinance blocks law enforcement use, funding and future contracts related to ALPR systems. The law destroys existing ALPR data and puts the ban into city code.

Tempe is the first city in Arizona to pass a law that bans ALPRs.

"We have an opportunity to be at the forefront of these bans of what I believe is a larger movement as we see bans like these around our state and nation," Council member Brooke St. George said before voting yes.

The historic move comes after Tempe said it was ending its contract with Flock, a company that produces ALPRs, because of concerns over the risk of misuse.

Chin called the ban on ALPRs "short-sighted."

"We created technology. We can adjust technology. We can make rules about how to use technology to help us," she said.

The East Valley city had 33 Flock cameras around town.

The ALPRs capture license plate numbers and vehicle information, which police said they used to find stolen vehicles, identify suspects and help solve crimes.

The ALPRs were part of the police department's Real-Time Operations Center, which debuted in 2024. The center still uses hundreds of other cameras to find evidence of crimes and help officers respond to calls more safely.

The ban won't affect the 20 Flock cameras that Arizona State University has on its Tempe campus.

Nearly a dozen cities, towns and counties across Arizona, including Tempe, have either ended their ALPR contracts, temporarily suspended them or announced they do not plan on renewing.

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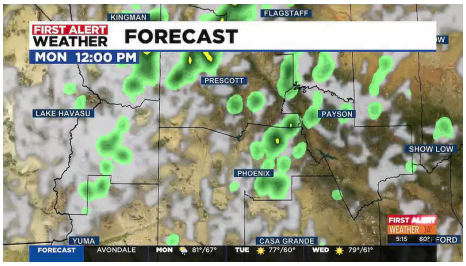


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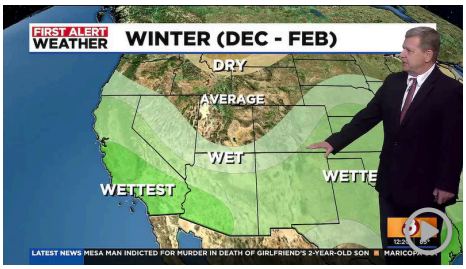





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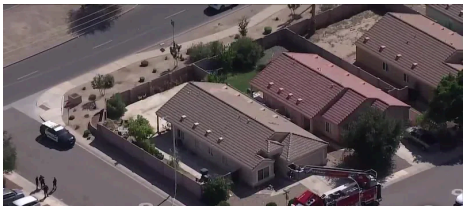



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